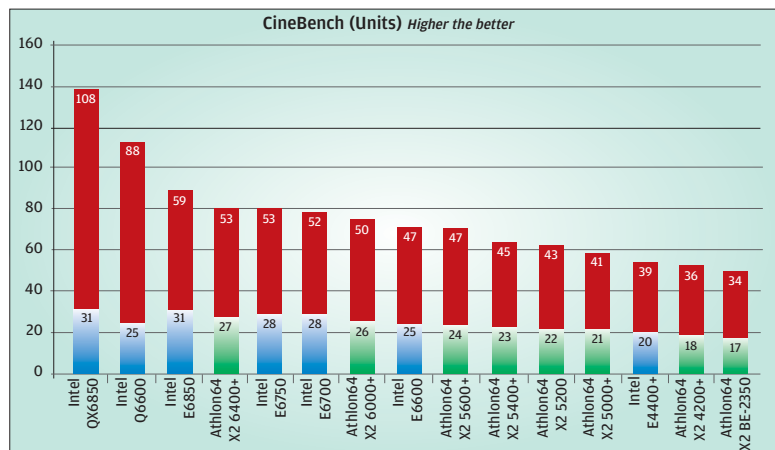


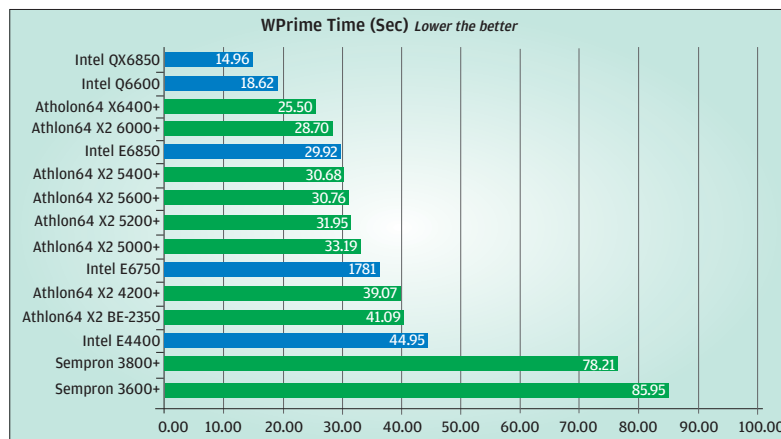
CineBench 10

The graph has two bars—the top bar represents CineBench's using all cores and the bottom bar is the performance achieved with just a single core. Intel's QX6850 rips apart the competition, as does the affordable Q6600. For the first time, the Athlon64 X2 6400+ makes it to the top league. Interestingly, X2 5200+ beats the Intel E4400 by a fair margin in both Single as well as multi-core environments.



WPrime

This time we choose Wprime over Super-Pi—it scales better with multi-core processors and clock speed. The results are a mixed bag, with Intel's quad-cores taking the top slots—they are able to work with four threads each time, and hence complete the calculation faster. On the dual-core front, higher clock speeds determine the results—the AMD 6400+ and 6000+ follow, ahead of the E6850 and E6750.



ScienceMark 2.0

Scientific calculations have always been AMD's strength and we've seen this happen in all processor comparisons. AMD's FPU completely dominates—the Athlon64 X2 6400+ comes out top, followed by the 6000+. Intel's QX6850 and E6850 are separated by a small margin for third place.

WinRAR 3.7

WinRAR's built-in benchmark gives a good indication of processors' capability at compressing files, and it also supports multi-threading. As

expected, the quad-cores have a clear lead. Except for the E4400, all other Intel processors are clearly ahead of their respective AMD counterparts.

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Intel QX6850

The Fastest processor money can buy

3D Mark 06 And PC Mark 05

The quad-cores are at the head of the pack, followed by the top end dual-cores from Intel. AMD's 6400+ also comes very close to third position in the 3DMark benchmark. These benchmarks serve as a good indicator of how well applications optimised for multi-core processors scale when presented with the right environment. AMD's Athlon64 X2 5200+ manages to stay ahead of Intel's dual-core E4400, and that's commendable.

Verdict

Overall, the scene hasn't changed much—Intel clearly dominates most of the benchmarks, except for scientific calculations where AMD's traditionally strong FPU gives them a small lead. If you want the best CPU available, it's Intel's Core Quad QX6850 which retails for Rs 52,000. However, we're all looking for value within our budgets, so read on to find out which processors give you the best performance for your budget.

Decision Maker

In this graph, we've normalised both price and performance with respect to Intel's QX6850, which is the best processor you can buy.

Reading the graph is quite simple—in a particular price range, compare two adjacent graphs. For example, let's take the Athlon64 4200+ and the Sempron 3800+. For a two-unit rise in price, you can get up to thirteen more units of performance from the 4200+, making it a better buy than the 3800+. Similarly, you can compare other models to figure out which processor gives the best bang for the buck.

We've divided the graph into three price ranges. The best performer in each category is used as a point of reference.